

Input Content (IC)

Score: 1/5 — Serious concern | Confidence: high

Benchmark: AFRIDOC_MT | **Context:** Amhara Region Agricultural & Microfinance Document Translation — Cooperative and Rural MFI End-Users

Input Content definition: Whether individual datapoint content is culturally and contextually appropriate for the target region.

Each section below is followed by an evidence table. Three types of evidence are cited: [QN] — verbatim quotes extracted from the benchmark paper; [WEB-N] — web sources consulted during assessment; [DN] / [DATASET-DN] — sampled datapoints from the benchmark dataset, with an interpretation note.

Justification

The input content gap is total. All English source documents are scraped from Techpoint Africa and WHO [Q18, Q22], and the Amharic translations were produced from this English source material with explicit acknowledgment of translationese risk [Q103, Q104, Q105]. The deployment requires Amharic content drawn from Ethiopian federal and regional proclamations, agricultural subsidy notices, land-tenure documents, MFI loan agreements, and cooperative governance materials — none of which appear anywhere in the corpus. Critical proclamation-derived term categories (cooperative tier names, land-tenure category labels, subsidy scheme names, MFI credit-scheme terms) are entirely absent, confirmed empirically across all sampled examples [DATASET-D9, DATASET-D4]. The source-language direction is also mismatched: the benchmark translates FROM English [Q103], whereas the deployment operates on documents natively authored in Amharic administrative register [WEB-10]. No public Amharic legal-administrative glossary exists [WEB-14, WEB-15] to serve as an external terminology anchor. Given the user's HIGH priority weight on IC and the empirical confirmation of total content absence, this dimension is at the floor.

ID	Evidence
Q18	"We scraped English articles from the websites of Techpoint Africa and the World Health Organization (WHO). The articles cover different topics of different lengths with an average length of 30 and 37 sentences for health and tech respectively." (p.3)
Q22	"Finally, we selected 334 and 271 English articles/documents from the health and tech domains respectively, which represents 10k sentences each per domain." (p.3)
Q103	"A potential limitation of our dataset is the influence of translationese (Koppel and Ordan, 2011). Since all source material translated originates in English, translated sentences in African languages may exhibit patterns such as unnatural syntax or overly literal phrasing." (p.10)
Q104	"Although we have not conducted an analysis to quantify these effects, prior work suggests that they can affect MT model performance, generalization and evaluation including direct assessment (Freitag et al., 2019; Edunov et al., 2020)." (p.10)
Q105	"Furthermore, AFRIDOC-MT may reflect a bias toward English in terms of structure, semantics, and cultural framing. We leave a deeper investigation of these issues to future work." (p.10)
D4	ፀረ-ተሕዋስንን መቋቋም (AMR) የሚከሰተው ባክቴሪያ፣ ቫይረሶች፣ ፈንገሶች እና ጥገኛ ተህዋሲያን — Amharic: antimicrobial resistance — health domain, WHO
D9	ኔስት ኮይን (Nestcoin) የሂሳብ መዛግብትን ለማጠናከር እና የኢዲሎን ምርት በኦንሶርድ እድገት — Amharic: crypto/Web3 fintech startup news
WEB-10	Ministry of Justice provides authoritative Amharic terminology — federal bureau translators are the preferred authority unrepresented in the benchmark (https://justice.gov.et/en/law/cooperative-societies-proclamation-2/)
WEB-14	No public Amharic legal-administrative glossary resource exists (https://github.com/EthioNLP/Ethiopian-Language-Survey)
WEB-15	EthioLLM resources do not include legal-administrative MT data (https://aclanthology.org/2024.lrec-main.561.pdf)

Strengths

- WHO health-policy subset includes some legally-binding international-law references (IHR, TRIPS) [DATASET-D17, DATASET-D18] — the only register-adjacent content, useful as a weak analog for numbered-clause discourse structure
- Amharic content is rendered fluently in Ethiopic script by native-speaker translators [Q23, Q24, DATASET-D2]

ID	Evidence
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Q23	"We translated the extracted 10k English sentences to the 5 African languages through 4 expert translators per language." (p.3)
Q24	"The translators were recruited through a language coordinator who is also a native speaker of the language." (p.3)
D2	አካል ጉዳተኝነት ሰው የመሆን አካል ነው — Amharic translation: "Disability is part of being human" — WHO health article
D17	አይኤችአር 194 የዓለም ጤና ድርጅት አባላትን ጨምሮ በ196 አገሮች ላይ በሕግ አስፈጻሚ የሆነ የዓለም አቀፍ ሕግ መሣሪያ ነው — Amharic: International Health Regulations — legally-binding international law framework; closest genre to legal-administrative register in the dataset
D18	ከ ቲአርአይፒኤስ ስምምነት ከፀደቀበት ጊዜ አንሥቶ የዓለም የጤና ስብሰባዎች ብዙ ውሳኔዎች — Amharic: TRIPS agreement, intellectual property law in health sector — international health-law language

Checklist

Checklist item definitions:

ID	Assessment Question
IC-1	Do inputs require region-specific cultural/geographic/dialectal knowledge?
IC-2	Does culturally sensitive content align with target culture?
IC-3	Flag inputs assuming Western-specific knowledge
IC-4	Regional annotator recruitment for culturally sensitive instances
IC-5	Document content issues harming content validity

Checklist responses:

IC-1: Yes — deployment inputs require region-specific knowledge of Ethiopian federal/regional proclamations (985/2016 cooperative; 456/2005 land; Amhara Revised 2006 + 252/2017 amendment) [WEB-8, WEB-10, WEB-12, WEB-13], Amhara-specific institutional vocabulary (ACSI, EABC, primary cooperative unions) [WEB-3, WEB-5], and Amharic administrative register conventions distinct from Addis Ababa standard. The benchmark contains none of this [DATASET concerns 1, 3].

IC-2: The benchmark's WHO and Techpoint sources do not align with deployment culture. The user noted contemporary documents draw primarily from federal/regional proclamation-derived terminology, which is absent. Cultural framing of the benchmark is described as English-biased [Q105]; the deployment operates within Ethiopian Orthodox Christian Amhara cultural context [WEB-11, WEB-20] with cooperative-mediated document interaction [WEB-3].

IC-3: Tech subset includes Western/global startup vocabulary (venture capital, crypto, Web3) [DATASET-D9, DATASET-D19] and sports betting [DATASET-D28] that do not transfer. Health subset is WHO-globalized rather than Ethiopia-grounded.

IC-4: Not done in the benchmark; required for deployment evaluation. Federal bureau translators are the preferred annotation authority [elicitation Q3] but were not represented in benchmark creation [gap_3 web search].

IC-5: Critical content issues: (a) source-direction mismatch (English→Amharic vs. Amharic-source) [Q103, CRITICAL Concern 2]; (b) total absence of proclamation-derived terminology [CRITICAL Concern 3]; (c) translationese in reference Amharic [Q103, Q104, MAJOR Concern 3]; (d) no ACSI/EABC/cooperative scheme content [WEB-3, WEB-5]; (e) no Amhara region zone-specific administrative vocabulary.

ID	Evidence
Q3	"We conduct document-level translation benchmark experiments by evaluating the ability of neural machine translation (NMT) models and large language models (LLMs) to translate between English and these languages, at both the sentence and pseudo-document levels, the outputs being realigned to form complete documents for evaluation." (p.1)
Q23	"We translated the extracted 10k English sentences to the 5 African languages through 4 expert translators per language." (p.3)
Q24	"The translators were recruited through a language coordinator who is also a native speaker of the language." (p.3)
Q103	"A potential limitation of our dataset is the influence of translationese (Koppel and Ordan, 2011). Since all source material translated originates in English, translated sentences in African languages may exhibit patterns such as unnatural syntax or overly literal phrasing." (p.10)
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Q105	"Furthermore, AFRIDOC-MT may reflect a bias toward English in terms of structure, semantics, and cultural framing. We leave a deeper investigation of these issues to future work." (p.10)
D9	ኔስት ኮይን (Nestcoin) የሂሳብ መዛግብቱን ለማጠናከር እና የኢዲዮን ምርት በኦንላይን እድገት — Amharic: crypto/Web3 fintech startup news
D19	ሼንቸር ካፒታሊስቶች (Venture capitalists) የ ኩባንያዎችን ማነት የሚያገኙት — Amharic: startup/entrepreneurship discourse — tech sector, no agricultural or cooperative content
D28	In dissecting the social impacts, it becomes vital to delve deep into real-life cases that embody both the positive and negative facets of sports betting in Kenya. — English: sports betting social impacts — not directly relevant to deployment context
WEB-3	EABC and primary cooperative unions are the institutional terminology anchors for deployment, distinct from health/IT translator preparation (https://addisstandard.com/sowing-under-shadows-of-violence-amhara-farmers-face-bleak-harvest-as-conflict-deepens-fertilizer-shortages-drives-up-input-prices/)
WEB-5	ACSI serves ~2 million clients across all woredas; key MFI in deployment (https://www.findevgateway.org/sites/default/files/publications/files/mfg-en-case-study-a-review-of-ethiopian-microfinance-institutions-and-their-role-in-poverty-reduction-a-case-study-on-amhara-credit-and-saving-institution-acsi-jan-2011.pdf)
WEB-8	Cooperative Societies Proclamation 985/2016 defines the operative tier vocabulary (https://leap.unep.org/en/countries/et/national-legislation/cooperative-societies-proclamation-no-9852016)
WEB-10	Ministry of Justice provides authoritative Amharic terminology — federal bureau translators are the preferred authority unrepresented in the benchmark (https://justice.gov.et/en/law/cooperative-societies-proclamation-2/)
WEB-11	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/East_Gojjam_Zone
WEB-12	Land Administration Proclamation 456/2005 defines land-tenure terminology absent from benchmark (https://land.igad.int/index.php/countries/37-countries/ethiopia/38-ethiopia-profile?start=2)
WEB-13	Amhara Revised Proclamation provides regional land-tenure framework (https://ukgreencitiesandinfrastructure.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/07/ICED-Ethiopia-land-administration-background-paper.pdf)
WEB-20	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/North_Wollo_Zone
CRITICAL Concern 3	The benchmark contains zero instances of the critical term categories identified by the user: input subsidy scheme names, land-tenure category labels (rist-derived terms, usufruct rights, holding certificates), cooperative membership tier designations from Proclamation 985/2016 (ቀዳሚ የሕብረት ሥራ ማሰባሰቢያ, የሕብረት ሥራ ማህበራት ዩኒዮን), or MFI credit-scheme terms (ACSI group lending terminology). The Amharic vocabulary in the dataset is drawn from health (disease names, medical procedures, nutrition, epidemiology) and IT (startup names, fintech terms, crypto vocabulary) — entirely non-overlapping with the deployment's operative terminology.

Information Gaps

- Whether ACSI loan-agreement Amharic templates and EABC subsidy notice templates are publicly available for use in a supplementary evaluation set
- Whether Amhara Regional Bureau translation unit maintains an internal glossary that could anchor terminology evaluation

Requires Expert Verification

- Native-speaker assessment of register-distance between AFRIDOC-MT Amharic and federal proclamation Amharic
- Identification of specific Amharic terms most likely to be mistranslated by AFRIDOC-MT-finetuned systems

Remediation

Gap 1: Critical proclamation-derived terminology (cooperative tier names per 985/2016, land-tenure category labels, subsidy scheme names, MFI credit-scheme terms) is entirely absent; source-language direction is mismatched (English→Amharic vs. native Amharic-source documents).

Recommendation: Compile a proclamation-terminology glossary using Ministry of Justice Amharic texts [WEB-10] and IGAD land-administration profile [WEB-12] as anchors. Build deployment test items in the deployment's actual source-language direction (Amharic source) rather than relying on AFRIDOC-MT's English source provenance. Document and probe specifically for translationese artifacts when evaluating models that have been exposed to AFRIDOC-MT-like training data.

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